

Benjamin Cohen

Senior Software Engineer

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📍 New York, NY · open to relocation

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Senior frontend engineer, comfortable full-stack, specializing in **design systems, real-time/multiplayer UX** (WebSockets, CRDTs), and high-conversion product interfaces. Built and shipped across fintech, healthcare, and ed-tech in React and TypeScript. Passionate about AI-native interfaces that make powerful tools more intuitive and accessible, especially for developers.

EXPERIENCE

-  Mercor (Contract)

Feb 2026 – Present

Software Development Expert

- Design rubrics and evaluation metadata for complex software engineering tasks to train frontier coding models.
 - Author assessments targeting deep imperative programming concepts (exception handling, race conditions, timeouts) to measure agent understanding beyond pattern matching.
 - Provide human feedback in RLHF loops to expand the scope and reliability of coding agents on large, real-world codebases.

React · TypeScript · SWEBench · OpenCode
-  Sabbatical · *travel and relocation*

Jul 2025 – Feb 2026
-  SoFi

Dec 2023 – Jul 2025

Senior Software Engineer

- Co-led rollout of SoFi's unified design system, building reusable React components adopted company-wide.
 - Redesigned the Student Loan Refinancing funnel using the new design system; partnered with backend teams to migrate the API layer from REST to GraphQL.
 - Designed and implemented A/B experiments improving conversion by ~3% resulting in a **\$12M monthly revenue lift**.

React · TypeScript · GraphQL · Optimizely
-  Code Platoon

Oct 2022 – Oct 2023

Lead Software Instructor

- Taught modern full-stack development at a not-for-profit helping military veterans transition to software careers.
 - Rewrote our assessments and built an automated GitHub Actions pipeline for instant feedback and CI/CD grading, reducing assessment turnaround from days to seconds.

React · JavaScript · GitHub Actions · Python · Django
-  DUOS

Nov 2021 – Oct 2022

Senior Software Engineer

- Owned all frontend surfaces (marketing, internal ops, and consumer mobile) for DUOS's senior-care platform.
 - Built robust automated testing (unit, integration, e2e) integrated with CI/CD to ensure rapid, stable releases.

React · React Native · TypeScript · MUI · Jest · Cypress

 ServiceMaster

May 2019 – Oct 2021

Frontend Developer III

- Delivered full redesign of flagship brand sites and checkout flow for **millions of annual users**, introducing Jest and Cypress coverage to ensure stability through the migration.

Ember.js · React · Jest · Cypress

 Fullstack Academy

Jul 2016 – Apr 2019

Software Instructor

- Instructor at one of the first major coding bootcamps, delivering full-stack lectures and leading curriculum migration from Angular 1.x to React (acquired 2019).
- Mentored **hundreds of engineers** now at top tech companies.

Angular 1.x · React · Node.js · Express · PostgreSQL

 Microsoft

Aug 2014 – Jul 2016

Software Development Engineer

- Developed internal UI tools enabling support engineers to train early AI models (Cortana) on Windows and Office troubleshooting flows.

Angular 1.x · C# · ASP.NET

PROJECTS

CollabCanvas

[Live Site](#) · [GitHub](#) · [Demo](#)

Real-time collaborative whiteboard with AI-powered natural language commands. Users manipulate canvas elements through conversational prompts ('create 10 red circles, align vertically with 10px gaps') via xAI API with custom RAG and tool calling for canvas context awareness. Built to explore AI-native interaction patterns, learning firsthand where LLMs excel (structured commands) vs. struggle (spatial reasoning, z-ordering).

React · TypeScript · Konva · xAI API · Yjs · PartyKit · Cloudflare

LLM UI

[Live Site](#) · [GitHub](#) · [Demo](#)

Chat interface for xAI's Grok API with real-time streaming and an explanation pane for contextual lookups. Select any text in the chat to get instant explanations from Dictionary, Wikipedia, or AI. Includes persistent history, GitHub-flavored markdown, and LaTeX support.

React · TypeScript · Vite · Vercel · xAI API · SSE

SKILLS



React / Next.js



TypeScript



GraphQL



Jest / Cypress



Product UI / UX



Teaching / Mentorship



Performance & Architecture



AI-Driven UX / Experimentation

EDUCATION

Johns Hopkins University · B.S. Computer Science · GPA 3.7 / 4.0 · Upsilon Pi Epsilon